Reproduction

All types of living things are able to produce 'offspring' (descendants) that are almost copies of themselves. This process is called **reproduction**. Reproductive systems enable living things to make seeds, lay eggs, have babies or produce offspring in other ways.

☞ **1** Read the following passage and then write short answers to the following questions.

In humans, there are two sexes: males and females. Both carry genetic material called DNA in their cells. When one cell from each partner combine, the DNA of the two parents mixes together. The male provides the sperm cell and the female provides the egg cell. The sperm fertilises the egg, entering through the cell membrane and releasing its contents. In this way, the two cells combine. The new cell begins to divide. It grows and develops into a new human.

a) What is DNA and where is it found?

_____

b) What type of cell does the male parent provide?

_____

c) What type of cell does the female parent provide?

_____

d) What does the word *fertilises* mean? Use your dictionary if needed.

_____

2 Unscramble the words in brackets to complete the passage about DNA. The first letter of each word has been given.

The (ticenge) g_____ material in a cell's (sunclue) n_____ is called (AND) D_____. The DNA works like a set of instructions for building and operating the new human. During (retioncudrop) r_____, the DNA of two (stenpar) p_____ mixes together.

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Reproduction CONT'D

The reproductive system

The reproductive system in humans involves sex organs that create sperm and eggs. It also includes physical parts that allow the male and female partners to ensure that the cells meet. These organs include the testes and penis in the male and the ovaries, uterus and vagina in females.

3 Are the following statements true or false?

a)	Reproductive systems enable plants to make seeds.	True	False
b)	Laying eggs is an important part of reproducing for all animals.	True	False
c)	In humans, there are two sexes: males and females.	True	False
d)	Both male and female humans carry DNA in their cells.	True	False
e)	Female humans provide the sperm cell and males provide the egg.	True	False
f)	The egg goes through the cell membrane and releases its contents.	True	False
g)	Cell division causes a new human to grow and develop.	True	False
h)	Reproductive organs in human males include the testes and penis.	True	False
i)	Only human females have ovaries, a uterus and a vagina.	True	False
j)	Animals do not give birth to live babies.	True	False

4 Select the correct word from the options in brackets. Circle your choices.

Once the sperm cell (fertilises / reproduces) the egg, the new cell begins to (divorce / divide). It forms a ball of cells that burrows into the lining of the (male's / female's) uterus, which is located in the mother's lower body. The cells (multiplex / multiply) thousands and thousands of times. After about 40 weeks, the human baby is fully formed and ready to be (born / brawn).

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